FORGE

Facilitating Opportunities for Reentry, Growth & Empowerment

A Peer-Led Mentorship Program at Dooly State Prison

FORGE is a 36-week, evidence-based program that trains incarcerated men to become certified peer mentors — reducing dorm conflict, strengthening rehabilitation programming, and building a safer facility for inmates and staff alike.

What FORGE Does

FORGE prepares men to facilitate evidence-based programs, mediate conflicts, lead restorative circles, and model accountability across housing units. Mentors operate within clearly defined boundaries — they do not investigate incidents, impose discipline, or replace staff authority.

The program creates a **self-sustaining pipeline**: certified mentors from each cohort train the next, building a permanent infrastructure of trained peer leaders.

How It Benefits Staff

Fewer conflicts — Mentors are trained to de-escalate situations before they become incidents.
Stronger programming — Programs like RISE and Pathfinders get trained, reliable facilitators.
More stable dorms — Consistent standards, peer accountability, and a culture of restraint.
Clear boundaries — Mentors support staff authority, never undermine it. Safety referrals are mandatory.

The 36-Week Curriculum

108 sessions. 3 per week. 2 hours each. Three phases with formal gate requirements:

Phase 1: Foundation
Weeks 1–12
"Know Yourself" — CBT skills, emotional regulation, conflict resolution, accountability

Phase 2: Development
Weeks 13–24
"Build Others" — Facilitation, motivational interviewing, simulation training

Phase 3: Practicum
Weeks 25–36
"Lead & Serve" — Supervised mentoring, certification, 60+ field hours

Built on Evidence That Works

Curriculum drawn from **Thinking for a Change** (NIC), **Moral Reconation Therapy**, **GRIP** (California), **Seeking Safety**, and **SAMHSA's Trauma-Informed Framework**. Program structure modeled on **PEP** (Texas), **RSVP** (San Francisco), **Defy Ventures**, and the **Oregon Mentors Certification Program**.

0.5%	80%	43%	$5 : $1	85%
GRIP recidivism rate (vs. 41.9% state avg)	Reduction in violent rearrests (RSVP)	Less likely to recidivate (RAND meta-analysis)	Return on investment (RAND Corporation)	Employment within 6 months (Defy)

Statistics from the evidence-based programs FORGE's curriculum is built on. Full details in the FORGE Program Overview at forgementors.org.

Leadership is not assigned. It is forged.

Positive Outreach Development Society, Inc.
Dooly State Prison • Unadilla, Georgia